

Safe Streets and Roads for All (SS4A) Implementation Grant Application Guide and Narrative Template April 24, 2025

The following information and narrative template were developed based on guidance provided by the U.S. Department of Transportation (U.S. DOT) in the [FY2025 SS4A Notice of Funding Opportunity](#) (NOFO), available resources on the [SS4A Program Webpage](#), from U.S. DOT Staff during [FY2025 SS4A Informational Webinars](#)¹, and grant-writing best practices. This guide was initially developed from information shared during a prior round of funding, and while we have made attempts to update the information to match the current NOFO, there may still be discrepancies, and if so, please follow the information provided in the NOFO. Following this guide and narrative template does not guarantee a funding award.

SS4A grants seek to improve roadway safety by significantly reducing or eliminating roadway fatalities and serious injuries through the development of Action Plans and refinement and implementation focused on all users, including pedestrians, bicyclists, public transportation users, motorists, and commercial vehicle operators. Funds will be awarded on a competitive basis to support planning, infrastructure, and behavioral and operational initiatives.

Safe Streets and Roads for All

- \$5 billion competitive grant program, with ~\$1 billion per year over 5 years
- Purpose: prevent deaths and serious injuries on our roadways
- Focus on comprehensive safety action planning, and implementing projects and strategies identified in safety Action Plans
- Inclusive of all types of roadway safety interventions across the [Safe System Approach](#)



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Safe System Approach: <https://www.transportation.gov/safe-system-approach>

SS4A Program website <https://www.transportation.gov/grants/SS4A>.

Application Deadline: June 26, 5 pm (both Planning & Demonstration Grants and Implementation Grants)

Available Funding in FY2025

¹Link to presentation slides from the 2025 Implementation Grant webinar:

<https://www.transportation.gov/grants/ss4a/ss4a-implementation-grant-how-apply-webinar>

\$680M is available for Implementation Grants

Award Amounts

Expected Minimum: **\$2,500,000**

Expected Maximum: **\$25,000,000**

Cost Share

At least 20% of total eligible project costs must be from non-Federal sources. This local match may be from in-kind or cash contributions in accordance with applicable Federal Regulations.

Learn more about cost share/matching funds: <https://www.transportation.gov/grants/ss4a/match>

Period of Performance

The expected period of performance for Planning and Demonstration Grant and Implementation Grant agreements may not exceed five (5) years.



This guide provides information about **Eligible Activities (B), (A1), (A2), and (C)** described in this image and the following slide. Refer to the Planning and Demonstration guide for more information about additional eligible activities.

- [**Eligible Implementation Grant Activities**](#)

Implementation Grant Activities

What does an Implementation Grant fund?

- Implementation Grants **must** fund the execution of projects and strategies identified in an Action Plan that address roadway safety problems, Activity (C).
- Projects and strategies can be infrastructure, behavioral, and/or operationally focused.
- Implementation Grants **may** also fund:
 - Planning, design, and development activities for projects and strategies identified in an Action Plan, Activity (B).
 - Supplemental planning and demonstration activities to inform the development of an Action Plan, Activity (A).



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Application Process

Applicants may only apply for either a Planning and Demonstration Grant or an Implementation Grant.

Applicants must be **registered with System for Award Management (SAM)** and have a **Unique Entity Identifier (UEI)**. Many municipalities are already registered with SAM and have UEIs, but please take a few minutes to confirm this – it may take several weeks to register. More information is available at <https://sam.gov/content/home>.

Submit technical questions about the SS4A program to U.S. DOT: ss4a@dot.gov by **May 29**.
Review Frequently Asked Questions: <https://www.transportation.gov/grants/ss4a/faqs>

Applicants may **request a pre-application review** be conducted by U.S. DOT to determine if an Action Plan meets the minimum requirements (per the Self-Certification Eligibility Worksheet). Requests must be emailed to ss4a@dot.gov by **May 9** with the subject line: “Implementation Grant Eligibility Review: [Applicant Name, State].” **Include the following attachments:**

- A completed Self-Certification Eligibility Worksheet (CRCOG can provide this to you)
- Hyperlinks or attachments to any plan(s) referenced in the Self-Certification Eligibility Worksheet.

Submit applications through the online application portal, ValidEval, before the deadline: https://usg.valideval.com/teams/usdot_ss4a_2025_implementation/signup

Required Application Materials – see U.S. DOT’s [Application Checklist](#)

Implementation Grant Applicants

- Valid Eval Application Form
- Standard Forms (SF-424 General, SF-424C, SF-424D, and SF-424LLL)
- Narrative (12-14 pages)
- Map
- Budget
- Self-Certification Eligibility Worksheet *required*

- **Standard Forms (SF)*** – see U.S. DOT’s [Standard Form HELP](#) document and [Fact Sheet](#); upload PDFs to ValidEval
 - [Application for Federal Assistance \(SF-424\).](#)
 - [Budget Information for Construction Programs \(SF-424C\).](#)
 - [Assurances for Construction Programs \(SF-424D\).](#)
 - [Disclosure of Lobbying Activities \(SF-LLL\).](#)

*If you have difficulty viewing the SF PDFs or receive the following message, download the files then open them directly. While Adobe Reader is referenced, you may not need to update your software.

The document you are trying to load requires Adobe Reader 8 or higher. You may not have the Adobe Reader installed or your viewing environment may not be properly configured to use Adobe Reader.

For information on how to install Adobe Reader and configure your viewing environment please see http://www.adobe.com/go/pdf_forms_configure.

Required Application Materials (Cont.)

- **Key Information Questions** - enter responses directly in [ValidEval](#).

Key Information Questions

- Lead applicant name and UEI
- Total applicant jurisdiction population
- Total count roadway fatalities 2018-2022
- Total average annual fatality rate per 100,000 population
- Inclusion of underserved communities in jurisdiction(s) and project area(s)
- Project area fatalities 2018-2022
- Project area serious injuries 2018-2022
- Project title and goal
 - Total SS4A funding request, non-Federal share, total SS4A project cost, and total other Federal funds (if applicable)
 - See Section F – Submission Requirements and Deadline – of the NOFO for a complete list

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Title	Instructions
Lead Applicant Name	This should be consistent with Q. 8.a. of the SF-424.
Lead Applicant Unique Entity Identifier (UEI)	See Section F.2 for more information about obtaining a UEI from SAM.gov.
Eligible Entity Type	See Section C.1.
Total Applicant Jurisdiction Population	Source: 2020 U.S. Census data.
Total Count Motor Vehicle-Involved Roadway Fatalities in the Applicant Jurisdiction that includes the last 5 years of data made available in the Fatality Analysis Reporting System (FARS) during the NOFO period	From the Fatality Analysis Reporting System (FARS) for the applicant jurisdiction. Use 2018-2022 data.
Total Average Annual Fatality Rate (per 100,000 population) for the Applicant Jurisdiction	The fatality rate calculated using the 5-year annual average from the <i>total count of fatalities</i> based on FARS data from 2018-2022, divided by the population of the applicant's jurisdiction based on 2020 U.S. Census population data.
Inclusion of Underserved Communities in Jurisdiction(s)	Whether the jurisdiction(s) covered by this application are or include underserved communities.
Inclusion of Underserved Communities in Project Area(s)	Whether the project area(s) covered by this application are or include underserved communities.

Figure 1 Excerpt of Key Information Table (Table 4 on p. 35-37 of NOFO)

Tips when answering the Key Information Questions in Valid Eval:

- For jurisdiction population, use Census Tract data from U.S. Census 2020; include all tracts that best align with your jurisdiction.
- For crash data, U.S. DOT asks that you use FARS 2018-2022 data when calculating the Fatality Rate for your jurisdiction so that this can be easily compared across the country. However, you may use a different source than FARS, but you must cite the source (provide a link, if available), and use reported data for years 2018-2022. Please keep in mind that U.S. DOT is looking for the number of people in crashes (not the number of crashes). If referencing data from outside of the 2018-2022 5-year range supports your application, you can mention this in your narrative and cite your source(s).

Calculating Key Application Data

Fatality Count	5-Year Average Fatality Rate (Per 100,000 Persons)	See the " Calculating Average Annual Fatality Rate " SS4A Fact Sheet for more information
 Total count motor vehicle-involved roadway fatalities from 2018 to 2022 <i>Example: 217 fatalities</i>	 Total count motor vehicle-involved roadway fatalities from 2018 to 2022 $\div$ 5 $\div$  Total jurisdiction population $\times 100,000 \text{ Persons}$ <i>Example: 217 fatalities ÷ 5 years = 43.4 avg fatalities</i> <i>43.4 avg fatalities ÷ 1,255,296 population = 0.0000346</i> <i>0.0000346 per capita × 100,000 =</i> 3.46 fatalities per 100,000 persons	



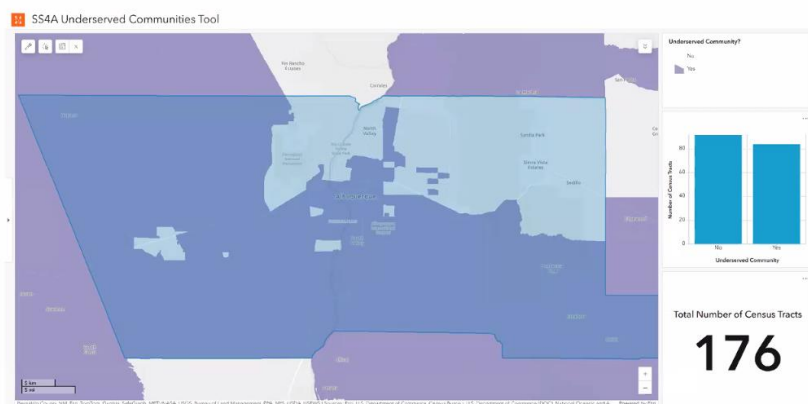
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- To determine whether your jurisdiction is entirely, partially, or not included within an underserved community, use the SS4A Underserved Communities Tool:
<https://usdot.maps.arcgis.com/apps/dashboards/9806be8527b14f93be311f0fb57d336e>

Population in Underserved Communities

- Use the DOT Underserved Communities Tool to identify whether your jurisdiction(s) are **entirely, partially, or not included within an underserved community**.
- When you visit the Tool, there are a couple of ways to find your jurisdiction:
 - Zoom and pan on the map.
 - Enter a location or address.
- Underserved communities are indicated in purple on the map. A visual assessment is generally appropriate to determine whether your jurisdiction(s) contain any underserved areas.



[SS4A Underserved Communities Tool](#)



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Project Area Fatalities 2018-2022	Count of fatalities in the project area(s). May use source other than FARS.
Project Area Serious Injuries 2018-2022 OR Project Area Injuries Severity Unknown 2018-2022	Count of serious injuries in the project area(s). Applicants without reliable serious injury data may use suspected serious injury figures. Please cite source.
Project Title	A concise, descriptive title for the project. This should be the same title used in the SF-424 form and the application narrative.
Applicant roadway safety responsibility (may select multiple)	• Ownership and/or maintenance responsibilities over a roadway network; • Safety responsibilities that affect roadways; • Have an agreement from the agency that has ownership and/or maintenance responsibilities for the roadway within the applicant's jurisdiction
Roadway users that this project will <u>significantly</u> benefit	Select from options in the application
Does your project include Demonstration and/or Supplemental Planning Activities?	See Section D.2.i
Would you consider accepting funding for only demonstration activities and/or supplemental planning?	Yes, no, n/a.
Total SS4A Federal Funds Requested	Must be a whole number (no cents).
Total SS4A Non-Federal Share	Must be equal to, or greater than, 20% of total project cost.
Total SS4A Project cost	Sum of Total SS4A Federal Funding Request and Total SS4A Non-Federal Share/Match.
Total Other Federal Funds Used (if applicable)	Must be a whole number (no cents). Other federal funds may include funds directly received from a federal agency or funds received through a pass-through agency (e.g., State governmental agency) that originated as federal funds.
SS4A Funding Request for Supplemental Planning and/or Demonstration Activities (A)	Must be consistent with Implementation Grant Supplemental Budget
SS4A Funding Request for Planning, Design, and Development Activities for Projects/Strategies (B)	Must be consistent with Implementation Grant Supplemental Budget
SS4A Funding Request for Carrying Out Projects and Strategies (C)	Must be consistent with Implementation Grant Supplemental Budget
Existing Comprehensive Safety Action Plan (or equivalent)	Link to or attachment

Figure 2 Excerpt of Key Information Table (Table 4 on p. 35-37 of NOFO)

- **Narrative** - more information below; upload PDF to ValidEval.
- **Self-Certification Eligibility Worksheet** (required for supplemental planning and/or demonstration activities and implementation grants) – **CRCOG can send you a recommended Worksheet, which you can customize with your UEI and upload as a PDF to ValidEval.**

Note: CRCOG Member Municipalities can use the current [Regional Transportation Safety Plan](#) (RTSP) and [Metropolitan Transportation Plan](#) (MTP) to meet the Comprehensive Safety Action Plan requirements to qualify for Supplemental Planning and Demonstration grants. CRCOG received an FY2022 SS4A Planning grant award to update and enhance the RTSP (track progress and get involved on the [project webpage](#)).

- **Map** – PDF and spatial format (e.g., Shapefile, .KML) showing the jurisdiction boundaries with roadway network; High-Injury Network or equivalent; and location(s) for projects and strategies. Upload the map file(s) to ValidEval. See the “Preparing your Spatial Data File” application aid for more information:
<https://www.transportation.gov/grants/ss4a/preparing-your-spatial-data-file>

Location and Map(s)

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- Need to show your:
 - Jurisdiction's boundaries
 - High-Injury Network or equivalent
 - Location(s) for projects and strategies
- Ensure that the map is of adequate quality for reviewers to understand your community and project.
- Submit the map in:
 - PDF file; **and**
 - Spatial format (e.g., Shapefile, .KML)

Example: Detroit, MI FY22 Implementation Grant Map

COSTS AND METRICS: RAPID IMPLEMENTATION

- Estimated cost of \$400,000 per mile
- 176 miles of proposed safety projects
- Approximately \$70.3 million of improvements

TYPICAL PROJECT CHARACTERISTICS:

- Reallocation of street space ("Paint & post")
- Quick build, quick impact
- To be completed within approximately 1 year of grant award

COSTS AND METRICS: ENHANCED PROTECTION

- Estimated cost of \$1,400,000 per mile
- 127 miles of proposed safety projects
- Approximately \$177.8 million of improvements

TYPICAL PROJECT CHARACTERISTICS:

- Full scope redesigns ("Concrete & curb")
- More substantial design & traffic interventions
- Long-term safety investments

See the "Preparing your Spatial Data File" application aid for assistance:
<https://www.transportation.gov/grants/ss4a/preparing-your-spatial-data-file>

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Location and Map(s) Contd.

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- Why this data is important
 - Program Evaluation
 - Communicating reach & impact of program
- How the data gets used
 - Check & validate application information
 - Tracking safety trends over time
 - Where the funding is going
 - What populations are benefiting
- Pro tip:
 - For applications with multiple project corridors, include a table of the segments in your application. Intersection # should match those listed on the map.

Project Corridors		
On	From	To
Main St	Franklin Ave	Cherry Ave
30th Ave	Steinway St	48th St
Broad St	South St	Pine St

Project Intersections		
Intersection #	Street 1	Street 2
1	Colden St	Franklin Ave
2	E York St	Gaul St
3	S 6th St	Walnut St

See the "Preparing your Spatial Data File" application aid for assistance:
<https://www.transportation.gov/grants/ss4a/preparing-your-spatial-data-file>



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- **Implementation Grant Supplemental Estimated Budget** – more information below; use U.S. DOT's recommended [Template](#); upload the xls file to ValidEval.

Required Budget Documents

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- **SF-424**
 - Distinguish between Federal and Non-Federal share in section 18
- **SF-424C** Budget Information for Construction Activities
 - Distinguish between Federal and Non-Federal share
- **Supplemental Estimated Budget** to distinguish costs by eligible activity areas – A, B, and C – and itemize major expenses
 - Budget Template Excel file provided in Valid Eval
- **Valid Eval**
 - Provide cost breakdown by Federal, non-Federal match, Total project cost, and Other Federal funds (if applicable)
- IG budget template and example budget:
<https://www.transportation.gov/grants/ss4a/implementation-grant-budget-template>

Itemized Estimated Costs of the (C) Proposed Projects and Strategies				
Activities	SS4A Federal Request	SS4A Non-Federal Match	Total SS4A Project Cost	Other Federal Funds (if applicable)
Implementation - Location or Project #1	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Individual Component for Location or Project #1	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Individual Component for Location or Project #1	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Individual Component for Location or Project #1	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Implementation - Location or Project #2	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Individual Component for Location or Project #2	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Individual Component for Location or Project #2	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Individual Component for Location or Project #2	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Subtotal Budget for (C) Carrying Out Projects and Strategies	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Total Budget for Activities (A), (B), and (C)	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -



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Budget – Submit an excel file using the Implementation Grant Supplemental Estimated Budget template to:

- Provide a high-level overview of estimated activity costs, organized by major cost elements.
- Itemize cost estimates by separating different locations and/or different sets of proposed projects and strategies that address a similar safety problem.
- Distinguish between three eligible activity areas:
 - A. Supplemental planning and demonstration activities in support of an existing

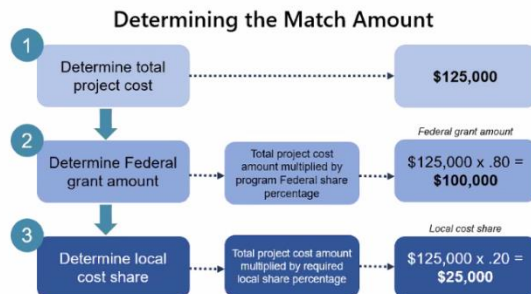
- Action plan;
 - B. Conducting planning, design, and development activities for projects and strategies identified in an Action Plan;
 - C. Carrying out projects and strategies identified in an Action Plan.
- Group funding sources in three categories:
 - Non-Federal;
 - SS4A funds;
 - Other Federal.
- Show funding sources for each activity and specify amounts for each.
- Identify funding amounts in whole dollars (no cents).
- Indicate estimated costs or values for in-kind matches.
- Do not include previously incurred expenses – costs incurred prior to execution of the grant agreement are not eligible for reimbursement without prior written approval from U.S. DOT.
- Ensure that figures entered in all application materials and forms are consistent.

Budget – Administration and Requirements

- Please account for the administration of a grant agreement, policy provisions, and reporting requirements:
 - 2 CFR Part 200
 - Civil Rights and Title VI
 - National Environmental Policy Act of 1969 (NEPA)
 - Domestic Preference Requirements
 - Labor and Workforce
 - Critical Infrastructure Security and Resilience
 - Other Administrative and Policy Requirements
 - Progress reporting on grant activities
 - Data submissions on program outputs and outcomes



Agreement Funding: 20% Cost Share and Match Reminders



- Recipients must contribute a non-Federal matching share of **no less than 20 percent of TOTAL eligible activity costs**.
- Grant agreements are expected to be administered on a reimbursement basis, and recipients will be reimbursed for up to 80% of their eligible expenses.
- Tribal Transportation Program and Tribal Transportation Program Safety Funds may be used as non-Federal match.
- SS4A will waive up to \$200,000 in local match requirements for eligible applicants located in the U.S. Virgin Islands, Guam, American Samoa, and the Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands; there are no other match waivers for the program.
- Local match may only be used once and may not be used as match for multiple Federal awards.



Narrative Requirements:

Narrative for Implementation Grants

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- Narrative – Up to 12 pages to respond to the selection criteria and describe the project readiness.
 - Up to 14 pages if including supplemental planning and demonstration activities. The extra 2 pages must be focused on responding to the “Supplemental Planning and Demonstration Activities” selection criterion.
 - The Self-Certification Eligibility Worksheet, Budget, and appendices do not count towards the page limit.
 - See Section F.3.iii.c for additional narrative style guidelines.
- Narratives should respond to the **Implementation Grant** selection criterion outlined in NOFO Section G.1.ii
 - Applicants are not required to follow a specific narrative format, but the structure should clearly identify the narrative associated with each selection criterion.
 - The Department recommends the narrative follow the outline below:
 - Overview
 - Location
 - Response to Selection Criteria
 - Project Readiness



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Implementation Grant Narratives

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- Implementation Grant applications that include supplemental planning and demonstration activities **may submit up to 2 additional pages of narrative, or 14 pages total**
 - *Note:* Additional pages must be focused solely on responding to the Supplemental Planning and Demonstration Activities selection criterion
- The Implementation Grant Supplemental Planning and Demonstration Activities selection criterion uses the same language as “Additional Safety Context” selection criterion for Planning and Demonstration Grant applications
- Narrative for the Implementation Grant Supplemental Planning and Demonstration Activities selection criterion should describe:
 - Scope of the work to be performed;
 - Roadway safety issues that necessitate safety activities; and
 - How the funded activities will inform an Action Plan.
- **For demonstration activities only:**
 - Describe how you will measure the potential benefits; and
 - Provide a brief schedule showing when the activities will be in place (e.g., hardware installed, when the pilot would begin, etc.), and the start/end dates of the work.



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- **12-pages max** for Implementation Activities; or **14-pages max** if your application also includes Supplemental Planning and Demonstration Activities. The two additional pages must focus solely on responding to the Supplemental Planning and Demonstration Activities selection criterion.

- Page limit does not include Cover Page, Table of Contents, Self-Certification Eligibility Worksheet, Budget Sections, and/or Appendices.
 - **Appendices** may include documents supporting assertions or conclusions made in the narrative.
 - **Letters of Support** must be submitted as one consolidated set of support letters in one supporting attachment.
- **Website Links** to supporting documents should be provided rather than copies of the supporting materials.
- Follow this outline (see p.38 of the NOFO and the Narrative Template section on p.11 below for more information):
 - I. Overview
 - II. Location
 - III. Response to Selection Criteria
 - IV. Project Readiness
- Font Size: no less than 12-point Times New Roman.
- Margins: Minimum 1-inch, all sides.
- Include Page Numbers.
- Upload PDF to ValidEval.

Purpose: Respond to Selection Criteria of Section G.1.ii of the NOFO and address the program requirements; clearly identify the relevance of each supporting document.

Application Ratings

Each criterion will be reviewed and rated as either “High,” “Medium,” “Low,” or “Non-responsive.” An application will receive a ‘High’ rating if:

- The application is very responsive to the criteria and is expected to advance safety planning.
- The narrative has clear descriptions of the work scope and the roadway safety problem to be addressed.
- The proposed approach will strongly inform an Action Plan; and
- For Demonstration Activities only, the narrative clearly describes how the activities will be measured and evaluated.

Implementation Grant Application Ratings

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- Applicants will receive a rating of High, Medium, Low, or Non-Responsive for each of the three required Implementation Grant selection criteria.
- Together, these selection criteria ratings add up to an overall application rating of:
 - Highly Recommended;
 - Recommended;
 - Acceptable; or
 - Not Recommended
- What *does not* affect the overall application rating:
 - Project readiness rating
 - Supplemental Planning and Demonstration Activities selection criterion
 - Award considerations



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Evaluation for *Both* SS4A Grant Types

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The Department will assess the narrative's alignment with the selection criterion and will assign a rating of "High," "Medium," "Low," or "Non-Responsive."

	High	Medium	Low	Non-Responsive
Rating Scale	The application is very responsive to the criteria and is expected to advance safety planning. The narrative has clear descriptions of the work scope and the roadway safety problem to be addressed. The proposed approach will strongly inform an Action Plan. For demonstration activities only: The narrative clearly describes how the activities will be measured and evaluated.	The application is responsive to the criteria and is performing safety planning activities. The narrative has descriptions of the work scope and the roadway safety problem to be addressed. The proposed approach will inform an Action Plan. For demonstration activities only: The narrative describes how the activities will be measured and evaluated.	The application is minimally responsive to the criteria. The proposed approach is weakly tied to an Action Plan. For demonstration activities only: The narrative provides minimal detail on how the activities will be measured and evaluated.	The narrative indicates the proposal is counter to the criteria, does not contain sufficient information, or is not connected to an Action Plan. For demonstration activities only: Detail on how the activities will be measured and evaluated are not included.



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Implementation Grant Selection Criteria and Considerations

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- **Three selection criteria:**
 - Safety Need
 - Safety Impact
 - Engagement and Collaboration
- **One optional selection criterion:**
 - Supplemental Planning and Demonstration Activities (only if included in the application)
- Additional Consideration: Project readiness rating
- Award considerations:
 - Received SS4A funds to develop/update an Action Plan
 - % of funds spent in underserved communities
 - Rural areas
 - Enhance the geographic diversity of Implementation Grant recipients
 - Principles from DOT Order, Ensuring Reliance Upon Sound Economic Analysis in DOT Policies, Programs and Activities
 - Infrastructure reducing lane capacity for vehicles viewed less favorably
 - Federal funding requests < \$10 million
 - Action Plans with all 8 components
 - High ratio of Killed and Serious Injuries per \$1 million in Federal funding requested



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General Tips:

- The goal of this program, and of grant reviewers, is to significantly reduce fatalities and serious injuries on the nation's roadways.
- Create a clear, concise, direct, logical narrative.
- Tell a compelling story, making connections about why your project needs the funding to solve the problem, and why the solutions you are proposing will solve the problem.
- Clearly define the safety problem that needs to be solved and clearly describe how your project will solve this problem.
- Tie detailed statements to evidence and data.
- Provide quantified or illustrative examples.
- Use pictures, maps, and other graphics to help tell the story and make your application interesting.

Implementation Grant Activities - Reminders

Reminders

- Projects and strategies must be identified in an existing, eligible plan.
- Projects and strategies outside of an eligible plan should not be included.
- Projects and strategies that cross multiple political subdivisions, safety issue areas, and corridors/roadway networks are permitted and can be bundled together so long as they are in an existing, eligible plan(s).
- Implementation Grants may fund supplemental planning and demonstration activities to inform an Action Plan. **Implementation Grants do not fund the development of new Action Plans.**
- Applicants may only submit a single application.



Lessons Learned: What Worked Well

- Clearly written, easy to understand narrative.
- Well-articulated, detailed, and logical connection between the safety problem, and the proposed projects and strategies.
- Scope and focus are well-defined and manageable to communicate.
 - Systemic projects had clear projects and strategies to address a specific safety problem.
- Strong, project-level details, data points, and anecdotes that align well with the selection criteria, especially for the non-Safety Impact selection criteria.
- Including supplemental planning and demonstration activities in your application; DOT updated the selection criteria to make it easier to give you a partial award.



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Lessons Learned: What Did Not Work Well

- Difficult to read narratives.
- Key narrative information in appendices; many attachments with unclear connection or utility.
- Underdeveloped connection between the safety problem and the proposed projects and strategies.
- Everything and the kitchen sink from your Action Plan.
- Common sense interventions that would complement the project are not included.
- Funds for projects and strategies with marginal safety benefits or are not on a High-Injury Network.
- Vague, high-level language without specific details to try to meet the selection criteria.



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Friendly Advice and Reminders

- The SS4A program will consider one application per applicant, and applicants may only apply to one type of grant.
- Applicants must have a finalized eligible Action Plan to apply for an Implementation grant.
- Applicants may pre-submit Action Plans and Self-Certification Eligibility Worksheet for review by **May 9, 2025, at 5:00 PM ET.**
- DOT encourages bundling supplemental planning and demonstration activities in Implementation Grants.
- **The application deadline is June 26, 2025, at 5:00 PM ET. Late applications will not be accepted.**



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Tips for Implementation Grant Applicants

- You can bundle supplemental planning and demonstration activities even if they focus on a different safety problem than your implementation projects and strategies or are at a different location.
- Funds to implement projects and strategies are **more competitive** than funds for supplemental planning and demonstration activities.
- Applicants can indicate willingness to accept partial funding for only the supplemental planning and demonstration elements of their proposal.
- Including supplemental planning and demonstration activities in an Implementation Grant application **will not** affect your chances of getting a full award.
- Submit your Action Plan(s) for pre-review to determine their eligibility.



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Examples of Responses provided by U.S. DOT in the FY2023 Implementation Grants Webinar:

Example #1, related to climate:

Option 1 – OK

Our proposals are doing sidewalks and bike lanes, and it's going to foster a mode shift and therefore are reducing emissions from motor vehicles.

Option 2- More specific

Our proposal for sidewalks and bike lanes is going to connect to key destinations such as X. Y. And Z. And create networks that will encourage short trips by walking and biking. This will reduce motor vehicle emissions through mode shift.

Option 3- Even Better

Our proposal for sidewalks and bike lanes. We're going to connect key destinations x, y and z. We've done stakeholder, outreach, and found people will be more inclined to like, walk with the proposed enhancements, and that they feel safe to do so currently. The current pedestrian bicycle counts show a hundred trips a day, and based on our modeling assumptions, we anticipate a ten times increase in daily trips by walking and biking. This will reduce motor vehicle emissions through mode shift.

Example #2, related to workforce development:

Option 1 – OK

Our project will produce good-paying jobs.

Option 2- More specific

Our project will produce one hundred good-paying jobs.

Option 3- Even better

Our project will include one hundred good-paying jobs, include at least fifty percent of the jobs for disadvantaged groups, and we'll also have apprenticeship programs, so that five high school students can learn construction trades over the summer.

Appendix A, Examples of Eligible Activities for Implementation Grants

Implementation Grants fund projects and strategies identified in an Action Plan that address roadway safety problems.

Implementation Grants may also fund supplemental planning and demonstration activities as described in Section D.2.i, as well as planning, design, and development activities for projects and strategies identified in an Action Plan (e.g., project-level National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) compliance, associated environmental review activities, permits and approvals, construction design, etc.).

Implementation Grant Activities

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What does an Implementation Grant fund?

- Implementation Grants **must** fund the execution of projects and strategies identified in an Action Plan that address roadway safety problems, Activity (C).
- Projects and strategies can be infrastructure, behavioral, and/or operationally focused.
- Implementation Grants **may** also fund:
 - Planning, design, and development activities for projects and strategies identified in an Action Plan, Activity (B).
 - Supplemental planning and demonstration activities to inform the development of an Action Plan, Activity (A).



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Ineligible Projects and Strategies

- ✗ **Projects and strategies whose primary purpose is not roadway safety.**
- ✗ **Projects and strategies exclusively focused on non-roadway modes of transportation.**
- ✗ **Capital projects to construct new roadways used for motor vehicles.** New roadways exclusively for non-motorists is an eligible activity if the primary purpose is safety-related.
- ✗ **Infrastructure projects primarily intended to expand capacity to improve Levels of Service** for motorists on an existing roadway, such as the creation of additional lanes.
- ✗ **Maintenance activities for an existing roadway primarily to maintain a state of good repair.** However, roadway modifications on an existing roadway in support of specific safety-related projects identified in an Action Plan are eligible activities.
- ✗ **Development or implementation of a public transportation agency safety plan (PTASP)** required by 49 U.S.C. § 5329.



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Implementation Grant Activities

Examples of Implementation Projects and Strategies (C)



Source: USDOT

Safe Routes to Schools



Source: USDOT

Bicycle Infrastructure



Source: USDOT

Highway Safety



Source: FTA

Transit Safety



Source: USDOT

Emergency Medical Service Interventions



Source: USDOT

Pedestrian Safety



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Demonstration Activities

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Image credit: Solomon Foundation

Demonstration examples: <https://www.transportation.gov/grants/ss4a/example-funded-supplemental-planning-and-demonstration-activities>

Demonstration Activities to inform an Action Plan

- Feasibility studies using quick-build strategies, low-cost, and temporary materials
- Manual on Uniform Traffic Control Device (MUTCD) engineering studies
- Pilot programs for behavioral or operational activities that include at least one element of the Safe System Approach
- Pilot programs that demonstrate safety benefits of new technologies



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<https://www.transportation.gov/grants/ss4a/example-funded-supplemental-planning-and-demonstration-activities>

Supplemental Planning Activities

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Supplemental planning enhances an Action Plan and could include:

- Topical, complementary safety plans
- Road safety audits
- Consolidating Action Plans components into a single Comprehensive Safety Action Plan
- Additional safety analysis and data collection
- Progress reporting
- Stakeholder engagement and collaboration
- Updating existing Action Plans

Supplemental planning examples:

<https://www.transportation.gov/grants/ss4a/example-funded-supplemental-planning-and-demonstration-activities>

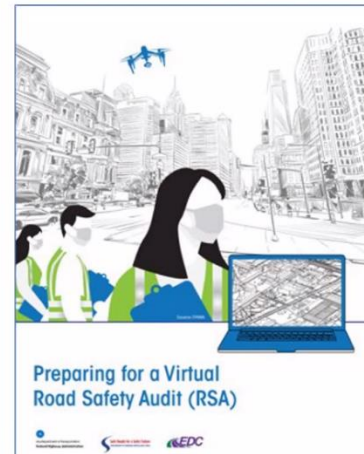


Image Credit: FHWA, 2022



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Demonstration Activities vs. Projects and Strategies

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Demonstration activities in support of an Action Plan (A2)

- Temporary in nature
- Pilots and testing, finite period
- Small scale
- Informs the list of projects and strategies in an Action Plan
- Assesses the benefits of an approach

Projects and strategies identified in an Action Plan (C)

- Listed in an Action Plan as a project and/or strategy
- Permanent
- Major construction
- System-wide
- Implementing the Action Plan



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Supplemental Action Plan Activities vs. Project-Level Planning

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Supplemental Planning in support of an Action Plan (A1)

- Expanded analysis and/or data collection;
- Follow-up stakeholder engagement and collaboration;
- Action Plan progress report development;
- Complementary planning efforts such as speed management plans, accessibility and transition plans, and lighting management plans.

Planning, design, and development activities for projects and strategies identified in an Action Plan (B)

- Pre-construction engineering or design for a infrastructure project;
- Documentation to comply with the National Environmental Policy Act requirements for a specific project;
- Right-of-way acquisition;
- Permitting for an infrastructure safety project;
- Developing advertising documents

Note: Any funds requested for (B) activities must be directly tied to (C) activities. E.g., if you are applying for (B) to design a new **roundabout**, you must be applying for (C) to build that same **roundabout**.



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See **Appendix A of CRCOG's Planning and Demonstration Guide** for more examples of eligible demonstration and supplemental planning activities, which may also be included in your Implementation Grant application.

Appendix B, Narrative Template

I. Overview

Provide an introduction and describe the safety context, jurisdiction, and any high-level background information that would be useful to understand the rest of the application.

II. Location

Describe the jurisdiction's location, the jurisdiction's high injury network or equivalent geospatial identification (use maps to communicate geographic or locational data) of higher risk locations, and potential locations and corridors of the projects and strategies.

You are not required to provide exact locations for each project or strategy; rather, the application should identify which geographic locations are under consideration for projects and strategies to be implemented and what analysis will be used in a final determination.

III. Response to Selection Criteria

Respond to the evaluation and selection criteria in Section G.1.ii of this Notice and include a compelling narrative to highlight how the application aligns with criteria:

1. Safety Need
2. Safety Impact
3. Engagement and Collaboration
4. Supplemental Planning and Demonstration Activities
 - (only if applying for supplemental planning and/or demonstration activities)

You must respond to each of the three criteria #1-3 and respond to criterion #4 if your application includes supplemental planning and/or demonstration activities.

IV. Project Readiness

Provide information to demonstrate your ability to complete the full scope of work in the application proposal within five years of when the grant agreement is executed, with a particular focus on design and construction, as well as environmental, permitting, and approval processes. Indicate if you will be seeking permission to use roadway design standards that are different from those generally applied by the State in which your project is located.

You must include a detailed activity schedule that identifies all major project and strategy milestones. Examples of such milestones include:

- State and local planning approvals;
- start and completion of the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) process and other Federal environmental reviews and approvals including permitting;
- design completion;
- right of way acquisition;
- utility relocation; approval of plans, specifications, and estimates;
- procurement;
- public involvement;
- partnership and implementation agreements; and construction.

Environmental review documentation should describe in detail known project impacts and possible mitigation for those impacts. When a project will result in impacts, if awarded, you must take steps to engage the public.

At a minimum, the project readiness narrative and detailed project activity schedule must include the applicability and disposition of: NEPA and Federal environment reviews and approvals; utility relocation; and right-of-way acquisition.

For additional guidance and resources, visit <https://www.transportation.gov/grants/SS4A>.

As you prepare your “Response to Selection Criteria” section of your narrative, please keep in mind the following Project Criteria:

A. Safety Need

Demonstrate the safety need in your community based on:

- Clear description of the safety problem to be addressed, including historical trends, fatal and serious injury crash locations, contributing factors, and crash types by category of road user.
- Crashes and/or crash risk are displayed in a high-injury network or similar geospatial risk visualization.
- Safety risk is summarized from risk models, hazard analysis, the identification of high-risk roadway features, road safety audits/assessments, near miss data, and/or other proactive safety analyses.

B. Safety Impact

U.S. DOT will assess whether the proposal is likely to:

- Significantly reduce or eliminate roadway fatalities and serious injuries;
- Employ low-cost, high-impact strategies over a wide geographic area; and
- Include evidence-based projects and strategies.

U.S. DOT will assess the extent to which the applicant demonstrates how the proposed projects and strategies:

- Align with and comprehensively address the identified safety problems.
- Are primarily on a high-injury network or address high-risk roadway features correlated with severe crash types.
- Significantly reduce or eliminate roadway fatalities and serious injuries involving various road users.
- Use low-cost, high-impact strategies and projects over a wide geographical area.
- Use evidence-based, Proven Safety Countermeasures or other effective safety countermeasures to significantly improve existing roadways.
- Use evidence-based countermeasures supported in NHTSA's Countermeasures that Work.
- Measure safety impact through models, studies, reports, proven noteworthy practices, Crash Modification Factors (CMF), and other information on project

and strategy effectiveness.

- Will have safety benefits that persist over time.
- Reflect established local policies, guidelines, and standards that improve safety decision making.
- Incorporate an existing Complete Streets Policy that prioritizes safety in standard agency procedures and guidance, or other roadway safety policies that have eliminated barriers to prioritizing the safety of all users.
- Consider the impacts of land use and the built environment to promote safe transportation design.
- Include at least three of the five Safe System Approach elements (Safer People, Safer Roads, Safer Speeds, Safer Vehicles, and Post-Crash Care) to address the identified safety problem.
- Incorporate technologies that promote safety.
- Are coordinated with, or support, State-identified safety priorities in the State Strategic Highway Safety Plan and its Vulnerable Road User Safety Assessment.

Implementation Costs:

U.S. DOT will also evaluate the costs associated with the proposed projects and strategies. Safety impact is the most important criterion and will be weighed heavily in the review and selection process. U.S. DOT will assess the extent to which the projects and strategies:

- Make effective use of Federal funds to address the location(s) of past traffic fatalities and serious injuries per \$1 million in funds requested, with data clearly tied to the location and relevant crash type(s). U.S. DOT will weight and combine injury and fatality data to assess this figure in relation to the requested implementation costs.
- Are itemized and summarized in a logical manner, including capital costs for infrastructure, behavioral, and operational safety improvements.

C. Engagement and Collaboration

This criterion supports the legislative requirements to assess the extent to which the application ensures investment in the safety needs of underserved communities and demonstrates engagement with a variety of public and private stakeholders. The response to this criterion should focus on engagement and collaboration in relation to the implementation of the projects and strategies. U.S. DOT will assess the extent to which projects and strategies:

- Ensure investment in preventing roadway fatalities and serious injuries in underserved communities including rural communities.
- Include demographic analysis, both quantitative and qualitative, and stakeholder engagement as part of the development and implementation process.
- Included or will include meaningful engagement with the public during all phases of the project such as planning, design, construction, and implementation.
- Leverage partnerships within their jurisdiction, with other government entities, nongovernmental organizations, the private sector, academic institutions, and/or

other relevant stakeholders to achieve safety benefits while avoiding negative consequences for the community.

D. Supplemental Planning and Demonstration Activities

Implementation Grant applicants should only respond to this selection criterion if supplemental planning and/or demonstration activities are included in the application.

U.S. DOT will assess whether the applicant has clearly and specifically described the demonstration activities and whether the applicant has described the scope of supplemental planning or demonstration work to be performed; the roadway safety issues that necessitate further Action Plan development, including supplemental planning, and /or demonstration activities, as applicable; and how the 51 funded activities will inform an Action Plan and support the identification of projects and strategies that will:

- Lead to a significant reduction or elimination of roadway fatalities and serious injuries involving various road users;
- Employ low-cost, high-impact strategies that can improve safety over a wide geographical area;
- Engage with a variety of public and private stakeholders;
- Adopt innovative technologies to promote safety; and
- Be evidence-based or build evidence around what works.

Applicants proposing demonstration activities will also be assessed on whether they describe their approach to measuring the potential benefits of the demonstration activities through data collection and evaluation.

E. Additional Consideration: Project Readiness

Project Readiness is measured by the extent to which the applicant will be able to complete the full scope of work within five years of when the grant agreement is executed. This includes information related to required design and construction standards, as well as environmental, permitting, and approval processes. U.S. DOT will evaluate the extent to which the application:

- Documents all applicable local, State, and Federal requirements.
- Includes information on activity schedule, required permits and approvals, the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) class of action and status, State Transportation Improvement Program (STIP) and Transportation Improvement Program (TIP) status (if applicable), public involvement, right-of-way acquisition plans, procurement schedules, multi-party agreements, utility relocation plans, and risk and mitigation strategies, as appropriate.
- Is reasonably expected to begin any construction-related projects in a timely manner consistent with all applicable local, State, and Federal requirements.

F. Award Considerations

The Department may consider the following when selecting SS4A Implementation Grant awards:

- Whether the applicant received SS4A funds in a previous grant round to develop or

- update an Action Plan.
- The percentage of Implementation Grant funds that will be spent in, and provide safety benefits to, locations in Census tracts designated as underserved communities as defined by this NOFO.
 - Whether the applicant is in a rural area.
 - Whether the applicant would enhance the geographic diversity of Implementation Grant award recipients.
 - U.S. DOT intends to apply principles from the DOT Order, Ensuring Reliance Upon Sound Economic Analysis in DOT's Policies, Programs and Activities when evaluating applications and making award selections.
 - Whether the applicant included infrastructure reducing lane capacity for vehicles or reducing access for emergency vehicles, delivery vehicles, and vehicles serving the disabled. These applications would be viewed less favorably by the Department.
 - Federal funding requests for project and strategy activities totaling \$10 million or less (supplemental planning and demonstration activities do not count toward this total).
 - Whether the applicant has a finalized Action Plan that includes all components in Table 1 by June 26, 2025.
 - Whether the applicant has a Killed and Serious Injuries per \$1 million in Federal funding rate that is high compared to other Highly Rated applications.